

Proposed Solution to #5824 SSMJ

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Statement of the Problem: Calculate:

$$I := \int_2^3 \left(\frac{\ln(x+1)\ln(x)}{x-1} + \frac{\ln(x)\ln(x-1)}{x+1} + \frac{\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1)}{x} \right) dx$$

Solution of the Problem:

We rewrite the problem as:

$$\begin{aligned} &= \int_2^3 \ln(x) \left(\frac{\ln(x+1)}{x-1} + \frac{\ln(x-1)}{x+1} \right) dx + \int_2^3 \frac{\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1)}{x} dx \\ &= \int_2^3 \ln(x) \frac{d}{dx} [\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1)] dx + \int_2^3 \frac{\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1)}{x} dx \end{aligned}$$

Using integration by parts on the first integral,

$$= \ln(x)\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1) \Big|_2^3 - \int_2^3 \frac{1}{x} \ln(x+1)\ln(x-1) dx + \int_2^3 \frac{\ln(x+1)\ln(x-1)}{x} dx$$

Notice the elegant cancellation of two integrals,

$$= \ln(3)\ln(4)\ln(2) - \ln(2)\ln(3)\ln(1) = \ln(2)\ln(3)\ln(4)$$

which is the required answer.